

Contact

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(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

IT Project & Program Management

Hardware

Product Development

Certifications

Certified in Planning and Inventory
Management (CPIM)

Lean Six Sigma Black Belt (ICBB)

Francis Tai

Product Leader | Connected Devices, Edge AI & IoT Systems |
OEM/ODM Electronics | Product Development, Supply Chain &
Manufacturing | P&L | CPIM | Lean Six Sigma Black Belt
Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada

Summary

I am a Product Development, Supply Chain, and Manufacturing Leader with 20+ years of experience delivering OEM/ODM electronics, connected devices, and Edge AI products from concept through high-volume production. As Founder & Director of Dale and Woods, and Co-Founder of Moosik, I have led product development, engineering, supply chain, manufacturing, and business operations with full P&L responsibility. Selected achievements: Delivered 27.3% revenue growth (~US\$81M / HK\$631.6M) and 7.7% margin improvement within two years. Reduced ERP inventory by 25.9% (US\$7.2M). Reduced lead times from 60+ days to 30 days. Improved throughput by 10%+ while achieving 95% on-time delivery. Led OEM/ODM product programs exceeding 100,000 cumulative units shipped. Most recently, I led the development of an Edge AI-enabled IoT platform integrating intelligent sensing, embedded vision, edge computing, and connected devices. MBA | BEng (Hons) Electronic & Electrical Engineering (UK) PGDip Electronic Engineering | CPIM | Lean Six Sigma Black Belt

Experience

Milo Enterprises Inc.

Manufacturing, Supply Chain & Product Development Manager | Edge AI Program Lead

November 2025 - June 2026 (8 months)

Vancouver, BC

Led development of an Edge AI-enabled IoT platform integrating embedded vision, intelligent sensing, and connected-device technologies.

Directed cross-functional product development across hardware, firmware, AI/ML, suppliers, and external engineering partners from concept through commercialization planning.

Defined product strategy, technology roadmap, system architecture, chipset selection, and deployment plans.

Managed supplier strategy, strategic sourcing, BOM optimization, project execution, and risk management.

Initiated and supported SR&ED experimental activities, BDC business expansion funding initiatives, and IRAP feasibility assessments by developing technical proposals, prototype validation plans, and commercialization strategies for next-generation Edge AI products.

Woods Global Ltd.

Founder & Director – Digital Product & Operations | P&L

April 2021 - April 2025 (4 years 1 month)

Hong Kong SAR

Held full P&L accountability for digital product portfolios including mobile applications, e-commerce platforms, and internal enterprise systems

Set product strategy and roadmap, leading cross-functional execution across UX/UI, engineering, QA, vendors, and business stakeholders to deliver scalable, revenue-generating platforms

Drove platform scalability and operational performance, improving revenue performance, system efficiency, and margin optimization

Dale (HK) Limited

Founder & Director – Product Development, Manufacturing & Supply Chain | P&L

March 2004 - April 2019 (15 years 2 months)

Hong Kong and China

Built R&D capabilities and expanded OEM/ODM operations across Asia, establishing end-to-end engineering and manufacturing capabilities.

Led end-to-end programs from product definition through chipset selection, supplier qualification, NPI, and production.

Established supplier management, strategic sourcing, and operational governance frameworks supporting business growth and organizational development.

Delivered high-volume consumer electronics products for Carrefour, Tesco, ASDA/Walmart, Bang & Olufsen, and METRONIC, including DVB-T product shipments exceeding 100,000 units.

Led cross-functional Sales & Marketing, R&D, Procurement, Supply Chain, QA, and Production Engineering teams while managing OEM manufacturers TCL (China-listed) and DXG (Taiwan-listed), and EMS partners including

Seastar (China-listed). Directed BOM/COGS optimization, strategic sourcing, P&L, KPI improvement, and commercialization.

Improved contract manufacturing throughput by over 10%, achieved 95% on-time delivery, and reduced lead times through Lean process optimization and supply chain improvements.

Led strategic negotiations, commercial agreements and semiconductor procurement exceeding US\$600K per purchase order, negotiating mask wafer/ MOQ commitments, allocation planning, and rebate programs to strengthen supply continuity, improve lead-time performance, and optimize procurement costs.

Pine Technology Holdings Ltd. / Moosik Ltd.

Co-Founder & Business Unit Team Lead – Product Development & Manufacturing (OEM/ODM)

July 2001 - February 2004 (2 years 8 months)

Hong Kong and China

Co-founded Moosik following the transfer of a business unit, engineering team, and project portfolio from Pine Holdings, leading product development, supplier engagement, manufacturing readiness, business development, and OEM expansion.

Led ODM-to-OEM transformation and new OEM product development for global brands including Lenovo, Creative, and Samsung following the transfer of programs from Samsung Korea's ODM business unit.

Aligned product roadmap, chipset selection, and cost-reduction strategies to enable scalable, cost-effective production.

Promoted to BU Team Lead within six months, leading cross-functional teams across engineering, supply chain, manufacturing, and quality.

Reduced ERP inventory by US\$7.2M (25.9%) within two years, achieving the lowest inventory level relative to the prior multi-year baseline and significantly improving working capital efficiency.

Ngai Lik Industrial Holdings Ltd. / Denca Ltd.

Sales & Product Development Lead

September 1999 - March 2001 (1 year 7 months)

Hong Kong SAR

Drove operational continuity and commercial execution during leadership transitions across Ngai Lik and Denca, including onboarding of a new Group CEO and Denca senior management, aligning product development, pricing, planning, and supply chain activities across a 15,000+ employee organization.

Selected for transfer to Ngai Lik Industrial Holdings Head Office to support group-wide business development, product development, production coordination, and strategic customer programs.

Led a team of 6 Assistant Sales Managers within a 20+ member sales organization, driving business development, customer engagement, team development, and sales execution.

Recognized as a top-performing sales leader, securing major OEM/ODM programs and leading DVD product development and market expansion initiatives during the company's transition from VCD and audio products to DVD player platforms, contributing to 27.3% revenue growth (~US\$81M / HK \$631M) and a 7.7% margin improvement within two years.

Managed strategic customer programs from opportunity development through commercialization, coordinating sales, engineering, and manufacturing teams to support new product introductions and market expansion initiatives.

Wai Kai Electronics Ltd.

Manager – Project Engineering & OEM Programs

June 1996 - September 1999 (3 years 4 months)

Hong Kong SAR

Assigned leadership responsibility for OEM program execution and business development initiatives, helping establish a newly formed regional subsidiary and supporting growth from approximately 500 to 1,200+ employees.

Led the company's transition from domestic audio product distribution in China to export-oriented OEM manufacturing and portable VCD product categories, contributing to production scale-up and approximately 25% annual sales growth.

Owned end-to-end OEM program execution, including engineering coordination, procurement, supplier management, manufacturing, logistics, and shipment execution for portable VCD player programs supporting SANYO and DAEWOO.

Managed product development activities including BOM ownership, engineering specifications, supplier coordination, pilot runs, and mass-production readiness.

Philips Hong Kong Limited (Sound & Vision)

Electronic Engineer / Product Engineering Support

June 1995 - March 1996 (10 months)

Hong Kong SAR

Supported design-for-manufacturing (DFM), reliability testing, and production readiness for consumer electronics products.

Contributed to defect analysis, PPM reduction initiatives, and quality documentation to support stable mass production.

Hi-Tech Precision Products Ltd. (Subsidiary of TOMEI International (Holdings) Ltd.)

R&D Electronic Engineer

September 1994 - June 1995 (10 months)

Hong Kong SAR

Designed CD Audio and CD-Graphics hardware and PCBs for Sony and Sansui OEM programs, including schematic development, PCB layout, prototype validation, and engineering documentation.

Successfully delivered CD Player, CD Changer, and CD-Graphics product development programs from design through verification, pilot builds, and manufacturing readiness, establishing an early foundation in consumer electronics product development.

Supported engineering verification, testing, and production transition activities, ensuring successful product launches and manufacturing readiness.

Demonstrated strong design capability, technical problem-solving, and project execution skills, earning recognition as a responsible, reliable, and professional engineer.

Education

University of Leeds

Bachelor's degree, Electrical and Electronics Engineering · (1991 - 1994)

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Business, Management, Marketing, and Finance · (2016 - 2018)

SIXSIGMA INSTITUTE

Lean six sigma Black Belt professional Cert.